policy that should yield long-lasting benefits to the Indian economy, once the numerous teething problems have been resolved.

Lamentably, there are also bad policies which have been badly implemented – and in my view and in the view of many eminent economists and public policy experts, the demonetization of November 2016 falls squarely in this category.

Demonetization touched the life of every Indian and impacted households, farmers, traders and businesses across the country. It was the largest demonetization of this magnitude, undertaken by any government, anywhere in the world. The country paid a very high price for this poorly thought-out policy, which was devastating in its impact, especially on the poorest people in our country.

This book presents the story of India's 2016 demonetization, which is analysed and explained based on my experiences as a banker, working not just in the world of investment banking and corporate finance, but also with very poor women in the remotest villages of India. It presents a perspective based on my personal experience.

Chapter 1 describes the demonetization saga as it played out, keeping the nation riveted for months, mostly in queues outside banks! It has the chronology of events in the 50 days that followed the announcement; reactions both in India and from abroad; the motives that were attributed for the move; the key announcements; the daily twists and turns in policy; the nationwide distress and inconvenience; and the mood of the nation as it turned from support to bewilderment, and then to disappointment. This chapter also illustrates how the note ban, presented as a surgical strike on black money and corruption, instead turned out to be more like a carpet-bombing of the Indian people and our economy.

Chapter 2 discusses the part played by the RBI. Since the RBI has been reluctant to disclose information pertaining to the demonetization decision, this chapter pieces together, from information in the public domain, answers to questions such as when did the planning start; the role of Governors Raghuram G. Rajan and